Leadership Brief

Reshaping Voter Outreach for a New Generation

Why This Matters Now

Politics has drifted from serving people toward winning elections at any cost. Citizens increasingly distrust politics, and traditional outreach methods — door-knocking and cold calls — no longer resonate with Canadians. People today value mobility, digital convenience, personal space, and proof through action rather than words. Persisting with outdated approaches risks not only being ignored but also damaging the party's image as modern and people-focused as well as its credibility.

The Strategic Shift

Winning future elections requires moving from *transactional* voter contact to *trust-based community building*. Instead of viewing citizens as binary "voters/non-voters,". Instead, engagement should be seen as a journey through stages of trust and involvement:

Citizen → Listener → Speaker → Voter → Organizer → Contributor → Leader

Each step builds trust and deepens alignment. The goal is not just to secure a ballot but to cultivate life-long advocates who grow with the party.

How This Works

- **Start with citizens**: Offer casual, non-political entry points (coffee nights, walking groups, social activities, volunteer service).
- **Move to listeners and speakers**: Through consistent presence, encourage small contributions of time and space to voice local concerns.
- **Show proof through action**: Solve visible problems — even small ones — so citizens see tangible results. Trust follows visible sincere service.
- **Enable growth**: Create roles for organizers, contributors, and leaders to expand reach organically.

Options for Engagement

- **In-person:** Coffee evenings, tree-planting, parent groups, movie nights, running clubs.
- **Online:** Always-on channels (Discord, Facebook groups), plus scheduled virtual meetings.
- **Use technology:** QR codes, online groups, lightweight sign-ups to extend engagement.
- **Door-knocking reimagined:** Respect personal space at the doorstep: a friendly hello and invitation to connect or join a social group is enough – *never an intrusive sales pitch*. Pamphlets should highlight ways to connect, not policy points.

Why This Will Work

- Aligns with generational expectations of respect, choice, and authenticity.
- Builds trust slowly and sustainably instead of relying on "black swan" events.
- Expands the pool of long-term contributors and leaders, not just temporary voters.
- Positions the party as the *only* trusted choice, not just the best of the moment.

The Ask

Adopt a long-term community strategy that replaces outdated methods with respectful, modern, and action-driven engagement. This approach transforms every citizen interaction into a path toward trust, contribution, and leadership.